



Feedback & Reflection

Practice Paper A – Listening into Writing

Discussion

Lecture

1. How easy or difficult did you find the live lecture overall? Why?
2. Which part of the lecture was easiest to understand?
3. Which part of the lecture was most difficult to follow?
4. Did the live lecture feel different from the recorded lectures you listened to earlier in the course? In what ways?
5. Were there any moments when you lost track of the lecture? What caused this?
6. How confident are you that you identified the lecturer's main arguments?

Note-taking

1. What note-taking approach did you use?
2. Did you try to write down everything, or focus on key ideas?
3. What information did you prioritise in your notes?
4. Looking back, what would you change about your note-taking strategy?
5. Did you leave space in your notes for critical comments, questions, or evaluations? Why or why not?

Summary

1. How did you structure your summary?
2. How did you decide which content from the lecture was most important to include?
3. How did you incorporate critical evaluation into your summary?
4. Which was more challenging for you: understanding the lecture, selecting content, or writing critically? Why?
5. Were there any points from the lecture that you were unsure whether to include? Discuss.

Language and Writing



1. Which academic reporting verbs did you use in your summary (e.g. *argues, suggests, claims, explains, notes*)? Which were most useful?
2. Did you find it difficult to paraphrase the lecturer's ideas? Which types of information were easiest or hardest to paraphrase?
3. Did you use any language to show evaluation or critical thinking? What expressions did you use?
4. Compare your approaches to criticism:
 - Did you evaluate the ideas throughout the summary?
 - Did you include criticism mainly near the end?
 - Which approach do you think worked best?
5. What linking expressions did you use to organise ideas and show relationships between points?
6. Did you have enough time to review and edit your work?

Marking Criteria

The full marking criteria are on Moodle. Based on the marking criteria, what would you give yourself for:

- A) Listening
- B) Writing

How do you think you could improve?

Looking Ahead

1. What is one thing you did well today?
2. What is one thing you want to improve before the final assessment?
3. What advice would you give another student you can offer your group for next week's assessment?

CHECK LIST

Your summary:	Did you do this?
1. SHOULD contain an opening sentence that identifies what the lecture was about.	
2. SHOULD indicate there is debate about how the state should regulate behaviour and may note that options include: a. Think b. Shove c. Nudge	
3. COULD contrast traditional economics (human are rational) with behavioural economics (humans can be emotional).	
4. COULD note that the lecture focuses on nudge in the context of social policy	
5. SHOULD define what nudge is and say something about how it works e.g. 'choice architecture'.	
6. COULD state that the theory was put forward by Sunstein and Cass in 2008	
7. SHOULD mention 1-2 of the criticisms of nudge e.g. manipulative, patronising, may not bring sustained change...	
8. COULD list some of the responses to criticisms e.g. No such thing as neutral design, need to take a societal view...	
9. COULD list some of the areas where governments use nudge e.g. health, donating, the environment, civil behaviour...	
10. SHOULD give 1-2 examples of nudge versus regulation e.g. organ donation, smoking, alcohol, diet.	
11. COULD mention the MINDSPACE framework	
12. SHOULD have a concluding sentence which 'wraps up' the summary e.g. by restating what the lecture was about.	
13. SHOULD have a range of linking expressions.	
14. SHOULD have a range of reporting expressions.	
15. SHOULD be logically organised & easy to read.	
16. SHOULD have some critical/evaluative elements	



List the language you used:

Linking expressions
Reporting expressions
Critical/Evaluative language

Opening sentences – which ones do you like best and why?

1. The speaker talks about a soft form of paternalism called 'nudge'.
2. The lecturer introduces the concept of paternalism and nudge theory.
3. Mike McGarvey talked about paternalism, which is very important across the social sciences.
4. The lecture, delivered by Mike McGarvey, introduces the topic of soft paternalism.
5. The lecturer introduces the concepts of 'soft paternalism' and 'Nudge theory', discussing the theoretical context and providing examples.
6. The speaker discusses how governments should control behaviour and the approaches of 'think', 'shove' and 'nudge'.

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7. The focus of the lecture is the way individuals or governments control people's behaviour.
8. This lecture is about soft paternalism 'nudge'; the speaker, Mike, began by discussing the extent to which the government should control behaviour.

Concluding sentences – which ones do you like best and why?

1. In conclusion, while the lecture provided a clear explanation of soft paternalism, it did not fully address concerns about individual autonomy and government influence.
2. The speaker concluded by outlining the MINDSPACE framework as a practical way of understanding how nudges influence behaviour.
3. In conclusion, although nudges can encourage positive behavioural change, the speaker's argument largely overlooked potential ethical concerns surrounding their use.
4. Overall, the lecturer presented a detailed account of Nudge Theory and its applications; however, some proposed solutions appeared more convincing than others.
5. In conclusion, the speaker used examples from smoking, alcohol, and diet to illustrate nudge theory, but offered limited evidence regarding its long-term effectiveness.
6. The speaker used examples of smoking, alcohol, and diet to demonstrate the role of nudges in public policy. He concluded with the MINDSPACE framework, arguing that nudges can be effective tools for governments, although the limitations of this approach were not fully explored.
7. At the end of the lecture, the speaker contrasted soft paternalism with compulsory regulation through examples relating to smoking, alcohol, and diet. These examples helped clarify the theory, although they focused primarily on successful cases.
8. Finally, the speaker concluded with an overview of the main points and reinforced the argument that behavioural interventions can support policy goals.

Sample (60-65)

In the lecture, Mike McGarvey discusses whether governments should regulate citizens' behaviour and argues that nudge is often a more effective approach than think or shove. While the think approach relies on people changing their behaviour through rational reflection, the shove approach uses regulations and punishments. According to McGarvey,



both methods have limitations, so governments increasingly use nudges to influence behaviour without forcing people to act.

The lecture explains that nudge is based on behavioural economics. Unlike traditional economics, which assumes that people always act rationally, behavioural economics suggests that individuals often make decisions that are not in their own best interests. For this reason, governments may need to help people make better choices. McGarvey supports this argument with examples of choice architecture, including yellow safety lines at train stations and different coloured recycling bins.

The speaker also discusses criticisms of nudge. Some critics argue that it is manipulative and may influence people without their knowledge. Others suggest that it treats citizens like children. However, McGarvey responds that there is no such thing as neutral design and that people still have freedom because they can choose whether to follow the guidance.

Overall, the lecture is clear and supported by useful examples. The comparison between different approaches helps explain why nudge has become popular. However, the argument would be stronger if more evidence were provided to show whether nudges create long-term changes in behaviour.

Sample (75♦)

In this lecture, Mike McGarvey argues that governments should increasingly rely on nudge, or soft paternalism, to influence behaviour because it offers a middle ground between persuasion and coercion. He contrasts three approaches to behavioural change: think, which seeks to alter behaviour through rational reflection; shove, which relies on regulation and punishment; and nudge, which attempts to guide choices while preserving individual freedom.

McGarvey justifies this preference for nudge through behavioural economics. Whereas traditional economic theory assumes that individuals consistently act in their own best interests, behavioural economics highlights the limits of human rationality. Consequently, governments may improve social outcomes by designing environments that make beneficial choices more likely. This principle is evident in examples such as platform safety markings, recycling systems and organ donation defaults, all of which alter behaviour without eliminating choice.

The speaker acknowledges several criticisms of nudge, including accusations of manipulation, paternalism and hidden forms of control. These concerns raise an important tension within the lecture: although nudges preserve formal freedom of choice, they intentionally shape decision-making. McGarvey responds by arguing that all environments are designed in some way and that the question is therefore not whether influence exists, but how it should be used.

The lecture is persuasive because it combines theoretical explanation with practical examples and addresses major counterarguments rather than ignoring them. However, the discussion relies largely on conceptual reasoning and illustrative cases. While the examples demonstrate how nudge operates, they provide limited evidence regarding the long-term

effectiveness of behavioural interventions. As a result, the lecture convincingly explains why governments might use nudges, but is less successful in demonstrating whether they consistently produce sustained behavioural change.

Moving from 60-65 to 75+

A 75+ answer is not simply a longer 60–65 answer. It is more precise, more analytical, better connected, and more evaluative.

60-65	75+
I understood the lecture.	I understood the lecture and can explain the significance of its ideas.
I report what the speaker said.	I explain how the speaker's ideas connect.
I mention examples.	I explain what the examples demonstrate.
I identify a criticism.	I explain the tension or problem created by the criticism.
I say whether the lecture is good.	I make a specific, qualified judgement about how convincing it is.

Upgrade your examples

A common 60–65 problem is mentioning an example without explaining its purpose.

60-65: description	75+: analysis
The speaker gives an example of recycling bins.	The recycling-bin example demonstrates how changing the structure of a choice can encourage socially beneficial behaviour without imposing a formal penalty.
The examples make the lecture convincing.	The practical examples strengthen the argument because they translate an abstract theoretical principle into concrete changes in behaviour.

Make your evaluation specific

Too general	More convincing
The lecture is clear and has useful examples.	The lecture is persuasive because it combines theoretical explanation with practical examples and addresses major counterarguments.
There is not enough evidence.	The lecture provides limited evidence regarding long-term effectiveness, so its examples establish the immediate plausibility of nudge more convincingly than its sustained impact.

Summary of Academic Language Differences

Feature	60-65 Sample	Example	75+ Sample	Example
Vocabulary range	Uses accurate but fairly general academic vocabulary.	<i>"...change their behaviour", "help people make better choices", "useful examples"</i>	Uses more specialised and conceptually precise vocabulary.	<i>"...soft paternalism", "coercion", "social outcomes", "behavioural interventions"</i>
Academic style	Primarily descriptive and explanatory. The writer reports lecture content.	<i>"The lecture explains that nudge is based on behavioural economics."</i>	More analytical. The writer explains significance and relationships between ideas.	<i>"McGarvey justifies this preference for nudge through behavioural economics."</i>
Precision	Ideas are expressed clearly but in broad terms.	<i>"...people often make decisions that are not in their own best interests"</i>	Concepts are expressed more precisely and academically.	<i>"...behavioural economics highlights the limits of human rationality"</i>
Criticality	Evaluation is present but relatively straightforward.	<i>"The argument would be stronger if more evidence were provided."</i>	Evaluation is more nuanced and engages with the strengths and weaknesses of the argument.	<i>"These concerns raise an important tension within the lecture..."</i>